

Auwa Structure

Last Updated: 20 July 2026

This file is the single reference for Auwa's corporate structure, intellectual property, trademarks, licensing, domains, and social accounts. Original documents are stored in `Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/`.

CORPORATE ENTITIES

Auwa Limited (IP Holding Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	17033727
Incorporated	15 February 2026
Status	Dormant (holds IP assets only)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining
Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Registered Address	167-169 Great Portland Street, Fifth Floor, London, England, W1W 5PF
Companies House	View

Auwa Limited owns all Auwa intellectual property and licenses it to More Air Limited for development and operations. Owning IP does not trigger "active" status. File dormant accounts annually (free, 5 minutes).

Activation triggers: Revenue exceeding ~£100k/year, outside investment, major B2B deal, or team expansion. On activation: license novates from More Air to Auwa Limited, domains/handles transfer, More Air becomes development partner.

More Air Limited (Operating Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	7051794
Incorporated	2009
Status	Active (trading)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining
Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Website	moreair.co

More Air handles all Auwa commercial activity: website, app, store, marketing, revenue, and expenses. Auwa is operated under an exclusive worldwide license from Auwa Limited.

How Money Flows

More Air client work funds the founders separately. All Auwa revenue is received by More Air Limited and reinvested into growth. Auwa Limited receives no revenue while dormant. When Auwa becomes profitable, a royalty structure (5-10% of Auwa revenue from More Air to Tom + Rieko personally) should be added. Flagged for accountant review.

More Air pays Auwa-related expenses (trademark filings, domains, hosting) and records these as operational costs.

TEAM

Following the traditional Japanese ukiyo-e model: eshi (artist) + hanmoto (publisher) as equal partnership.

Rieko Maeda, Creator (Eshi): Japanese-born illustrator from Kansai, also known by her artist name Eko. Creator of the Auwa universe (2015 onwards). Native Japanese speaker. 20+ years design and illustration. Leads: character art, seasonal content, figure design, creative direction, Japanese craftsman outreach. (Legal name: Rieko Vining.)

Thomas Vining, Producer (Hanmoto): Design technologist and brand strategist. 20+ years experience (Nokia, Apple, Sky). Built and operated a Japanese multi-merchant platform (2005-2007). Leads: app design and build, brand, business development, marketing, project oversight, store platform and operations.

Capacity: Tuesday to Friday (3-4 day week, 10am-6pm). Auwa gets 60%, More Air 25%, ventures 10%. No work Monday. Health and relationship come before any deadline.

OWNERSHIP CHAIN (IP)

1. Rieko + Tom created all Auwa IP (artwork, stories, name, character) from ~2015 onwards
 2. IP assigned from personal names to Auwa Limited via Assignment Agreement (23 February 2026)
 3. Auwa Limited licenses IP to More Air Limited for development/operations
 4. More Air handles all commercial activity (website, app, store, marketing)
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TRADEMARKS

Word Mark: "Auwa" — Batch 1

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004341028
Filed	15 February 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	9, 16, 20, 41
Priority Date	15 February 2026
Cost	£320
Status	REGISTERED (15 May 2026, no opposition)
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 1/

Nice Classification:

- **Class 9:** Software, mobile apps, downloadable content
- **Class 16:** Books, printed matter, illustrations

- **Class 20:** Decorative objects, figurines (non-toy)
- **Class 41:** Entertainment, exhibitions, publishing, music services

Expected registration: ~May 2026 (2 months from advertisement date, if no opposition).

Word Mark: "Auwa" — Batch 2

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004373944
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	25, 28, 35
Cost	£325
Status	Pending (per WIPO Global Brand Database, July 2026)
Owner	Auwa Limited
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 2/

Nice Classification (exact register wording, verified against WIPO Global Brand Database 20 Jul 2026):

- **Class 25:** clothing, footwear, headwear; t-shirts; sweatshirts; hoodies; sweaters; jackets; tops; printed t-shirts; graphic t-shirts; casual clothing; loungewear; sleepwear; scarves; hats; caps; beanies; socks; clothing featuring artistic illustrations and seasonal designs
- **Class 28:** toys, games, and playthings; collectible toys; collectible figures; collectible figurines; vinyl toys; designer toys; art toys; display figurines; decorative toy figures; limited edition collectible figures; blind box toys; character toys; ornamental toy figures; miniature figurines; toy figures featuring illustrated characters
- **Class 35:** online retail store services relating to wellness software, mobile applications, downloadable digital content, books, illustrated books, printed publications, art prints, posters, calendars, notebooks, stationery, greeting cards, figurines, works of art, ornaments, collectible toys, collectible figures, vinyl toys, designer toys, art toys, clothing, t-shirts, sweatshirts, hoodies, sweaters, jackets, hats, caps, scarves, socks

(Note: "decorative objects" is in Class 20 of the Batch 1 word mark and in the design mark, NOT in Class 35.)

Combined word mark coverage: Batch 1 + Batch 2 gives Auwa word mark protection across **7 classes** (9, 16, 20, 25, 28, 35, 41) in the UK.

TM3A Amendment — DECLINED

An attempt to add Classes 25, 28, 35 via TM3A form (~23 February 2026, £150) was declined. TM3A only allows transfer of goods between existing classes, not addition of new classes. Fee refunded. This led to the Batch 2 filing above.

Ownership Transfer (TM16)

Field	Detail
Form	TM16
Transfer	From Thomas Vining + Rieko Vining to Auwa Limited
Filed	~24 February 2026
Cost	£50
Status	Confirmed (26 February 2026)
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/ownership/

Design Mark: Auwa Character

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa character silhouette (full, with arms)
Application No.	UK00004373930
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	20 (decorative objects), 28 (toys)
Cost	£265

Invoice No.	1026117494
Payment Ref	L8PTTUYSY
Owner	Auwa Limited
Status	Published 3 July 2026 (journal 2026/027); opposition period runs to ~3 September 2026
Image Format	Black silhouette on white background
Artwork	trademark/3 design mark/artwork/auwa.ai and auwa.png
Documents	trademark/3 design mark/application/01-*.pdf

Filed as standard black-on-white (not colour-specific) following the KAWS precedent, allowing enforcement in any colour variant. Single application for the full character with arms. Simplified "without arms" version deferred unless needed later.

Evidence (Character Creation Dates)

Evidence supporting Rieko's creation of the Auwa character from 2015 onwards, stored in trademark/3 design mark/evidence/ :

- **artwork/files/** — Original Illustrator files dated 2016-2020
- **artwork/screenshots/** — File property screenshots showing creation dates
- **linkedin/20170710/** — LinkedIn posts from July 2017 showing Auwa character publicly shared
- **gemini/** — Screenshots from AI chat proving character discussion predates filings

Trademark Searches

WIPO Global Brand Database: Clean. No conflicting marks in Auwa's target classes. **Google Image Search:** No conflicting character designs found. **UK IPO:** Keyword search for "Auwa" returned zero results in relevant classes. Screenshots saved in trademark/3 design mark/search/ .

INTERNATIONAL FILING (Madrid Protocol)

DECISION MADE (15 July 2026): file comprehensively now, both marks, four core markets. Tom and Rieko chose the full-perimeter option over the earlier lean/deferred plan. Rationale: the capital cost is negligible against net worth and the risk of a first-to-file squatter (especially in China, the likely manufacturing base for the figure) is real once the character and name are public. Auwa is a product ecosystem, not an anonymous artist moniker, so the norm is to protect *before* launch. This also buys total mental clarity — no multi-year WIPO calendar dictating attention. The earlier "word mark only / design deferred to Year 2 / £650-1,050" plan is **retired**.

What is being filed

Mark	Classes	Territories	WIPO fee
Word mark ("Auwa")	9, 16, 20, 25, 28, 35, 41 (all 7 UK classes; JP excludes 25)	JP, US, EU, CN	CHF 7,571
Design mark (figure silhouette)	20, 28	JP, US, EU, CN	CHF 3,169
		Total	CHF 10,740 (~£9,600) + 2× £50 IPO handling

These are **two separate international applications** (different marks = different international registrations, each its own MM2 and basic fee). Word mark rests on the UK bases: Batch 1 (registered, classes 9/16/20/41) + Batch 2 (pending, classes 25/28/35). Design mark rests on the UK design mark (published, pending registration).

Fees are the WIPO Fee Calculator figures of 20 Jul 2026 (mark black & white, office of origin UK). Breakdown per mark: basic 653 CHF + individual fees per party (no complementary/supplementary — all four are individual-fee jurisdictions). Word mark: JP **1,261 (6 classes — class 25 dropped from Japan)** + US 3,220 + EU 1,557 + CN 880. Design mark: JP 429 + US 920 + EU 837 + CN 330. The word-mark fee summary PDF in the folder still shows the 7-class Japan figure (7,779); the amount to pay is **7,571. Re-run the calculator immediately before paying** in case the fee schedule changes.

Applications FILED (20 Jul 2026)

Both international applications **emailed to internationaltrademarks@ipo.gov.uk on 20 Jul 2026** (two separate emails, each with MM2 + continuation sheet + MM18). Signed by

Thomas Vining (Director) and dated 20/07/2026. £50 IPO handling fee paid online per mark, from More Air:

- Word mark — FS4 payment reference **HJ74X644X6**
- Design mark — FS4 payment reference **KUVHCCJHVR**

Source forms stored in `trademark/4 global expansion/application/`. WIPO fees (CHF 7,571 word / CHF 3,169 design) still to be paid to WIPO directly once billed after certification. **Now awaiting IPO certification** (payment receipt ~5 days; certification or deficiency notice within ~15 working days), then onward transmission to WIPO.

What happens next (post-filing)

1. **UK IPO** certifies the applications match the UK basic marks and forwards to WIPO. If any deficiency, they email; respond and resend.
2. **WIPO** examines formalities. Possible "irregularity" notices (classification, fees) — fixable. Then records the International Registration, assigns an IR number, publishes in the WIPO Gazette, notifies each designated office, and bills the CHF fees.
3. **Each designated office (JP, US, EU, CN)** examines under its own law within the Madrid deadline (12 or 18 months). Each either grants protection or issues a **provisional refusal** (relative grounds = conflicting mark, or absolute = descriptiveness, or a query on the goods wording). Most likely touch-points: **US** (USPTO tends to query goods/services specificity), **EU** (a 3-month third-party opposition window after publication), **China** (relative-grounds check). Japan class 25 was dropped, so no Juno refusal expected.
4. **Responding to a provisional refusal usually requires a LOCAL attorney** in that country (national offices require a local address for service; WIPO cannot represent you). Budget for this only if a refusal actually lands. Claude can help triage/strategise, but the formal response is filed by local counsel.
5. No refusal within the deadline = automatic **statement of grant of protection**. Full process typically 12–18 months per territory; the IR itself is recorded within a few weeks.

Payment routing (preserves Auwa Ltd dormancy)

More Air Limited pays WIPO directly. Do NOT route through Auwa Limited — a payment or cross-charge would end its dormant status and trigger tax filings. Because More Air is the exclusive licensee trading on the IP, the trademark cost is "wholly and exclusively" for More Air's trade and is an allowable Corporation Tax deduction. Set up the WIPO account in More Air's name, pay from a More Air card/account, save the receipt alongside the licence agreement. Do

NOT let More Air invoice Auwa Ltd for it. True net personal cost after CT relief and dividend-tax-avoided is roughly £5,200-7,300 depending on marginal rate.

Priority deadlines (the only hard clocks)

- **15 Aug 2026** — word mark classes 9, 16, 20, 41 (Batch 1 priority, 15 Feb). File the whole word-mark MM2 by this date; a single application can carry multiple priority claims, so classes 25/28/35 (Batch 2 priority, 16 Apr, live until 16 Oct) can ride in the same filing.
- **16 Oct 2026** — design mark (filed 16 Apr) and word-mark classes 25/28/35 if for any reason they're split into a later filing.

Sequencing plan — RESOLVED

Tom asked **Laura McLoughlin** (UK IPO) whether the two pending marks (Batch 2 word mark, design mark) could be registered before the Madrid filing. Reply (15 Jul 2026): they are in the publication phase, opposition period ends **3 Sep 2026**, and if unopposed they register ~~2 weeks later~~ (****17 Sep 2026****); the timeline is a legal requirement and cannot be accelerated. Decision: filed anyway on 20 Jul (word mark had a hard 15 Aug priority deadline regardless). The two pending bases therefore carry the 5-year "central attack" dependency until they register — low risk given no opposition flagged, with paid "transformation" into national filings as a safety valve if a base ever failed.

Known conflict to handle: Japan class 25 — DECISION: drop from Japan

Juno International holds "Auwa" in Japan including **class 25** (clothing). Japan examines earlier rights on its own initiative, so a class-25 designation there would be refused (senior identical mark). **Decision (20 Jul 2026): drop class 25 from the Japan designation.** Done on the word-mark MM2 via an item 10(b) limitation: "The designation of Japan is limited to Classes 9, 16, 20, 28, 35 and 41. Protection is NOT sought in Japan for Class 25." This lowers Japan's individual fee from CHF 1,469 (7 classes) to **CHF 1,261 (6 classes)**, saving ~£185; the word-mark total drops to CHF 7,571. No separate communication to WIPO/IPO is needed — the limitation is a standard MM2 field the IPO certifies and WIPO records. The WIPO fee calculator can't isolate one class per country in a combined run, so the fee summary PDF still shows 7 classes; Japan's 6-class fee (1,261) is confirmed by the per-class fee structure and can be re-verified via a Japan-only 6-class calculator run. All other filed classes are clear in Japan (Juno's 3/10/14/18 don't overlap).

Later relocation to Japan (noted, not yet planned)

If Tom and Rieko permanently relocate and move the brand to a Japanese Auwa entity, the international registration can be reassigned to the new owner for a small administrative WIPO fee (per Gemini). Not a near-term action; recorded so the option is known.

Adding territories later (if ever)

Subsequent designation (form MM4) extends the existing international registration to a new country for ~CHF 300 base + that country's individual fee. So Korea, Indonesia, etc. (the wider KAWS-style perimeter) can be added cheaply later if manufacturing or counterfeit activity ever justifies it. No need to over-file now beyond the four core markets.

Japan: Juno International Conflict

Field	Detail
Existing Mark	"Auwa" registered in Japan by Juno International
Japan Application No.	第6712100号
Juno's Classes	3 (cosmetics), 10 (medical), 14 (jewellery), 18 (leather goods), 25 (clothing)
Overlap with Auwa	None in core classes
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/exclusions/juno- international.txt

Safe in Japan: App, books, figurines, wooden objects, digital experiences, entertainment, toys/collectibles. **Blocked in Japan:** Class 25 (clothing) — Juno's class. **Decision is to drop class 25 from the Japan Madrid designation** (item 10(b) limitation on the word-mark MM2), saving ~£185 (see "Known conflict to handle: Japan class 25" above). **Options (deferred):** Contact Juno, challenge for non-use, or negotiate. Japanese IP lawyer ~£1,500-2,000.

Other Conflicts

WashTec (industrial cleaning) owns "Auwa" in their industry. Zero class overlap. Risk of challenge: 5-10%. **Sony** had an expired Class 9 filing (expired 2017). No longer relevant.

COPYRIGHT

Rieko's artwork is automatically protected from moment of creation under the Berne Convention (UK, EU, USA, Japan). No registration required.

Evidence: Illustrator files from 2016 onwards, LinkedIn posts from July 2017, 4 completed illustrated books, Dropbox files with modification dates.

Formal registration (not pursued): UK IPO £30, US Copyright Office \$65, Chinese registration £100-200. All deferred given the volume of dated evidence already held.

Copyright protects the specific artwork (stops exact copying). Trademark (design mark) protects the character shape as brand identifier (stops commercial use of similar shapes). Both needed for full protection.

LICENSING AGREEMENTS

IP Assignment: Personal to Auwa Limited (Active)

Field	Detail
Date	23 February 2026
Assignors	Rieko Vining + Thomas Vining
Assignee	Auwa Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Consideration	£1 nominal
Covers	UK Trademark UK00004341028, all copyright in Auwa character/illustrations/books/stories, all future IP rights
Document	trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_assignment.pdf

Operating License: Auwa Limited to More Air (Active)

Field	Detail
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Date	23 February 2026
Licensor	Auwa Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Licensee	More Air Limited (Company No. 7051794)
Grant	Exclusive, worldwide license to use, develop, and commercialise Auwa character, trademarks, and associated IP
Sublicensing	Permitted (e.g. for hotel B2B)
Consideration	£1 nominal (royalty-free for now)
Termination	30 days written notice by either party
Historical clause	Acknowledges More Air's development since 2017 under verbal agreement
Document	trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_license.pdf

Original License (Superseded)

The first license (14 February 2026, personal to More Air) is superseded by the structure above. Archived in trademark/1 license/_archive/.

DOMAINS

Domain	Purpose
auwa.life	Primary (brand home, website)
auwalife.com	Redirect to auwa.life
auwa.app	App (Kokoro Mirror)
auwaapp.com	Redirect to auwa.app
auwa.world	Story/brand universe
auwaworld.com	Redirect

auwa.store	Shop
auwastore.com	Redirect
auwa.co.uk	UK legal protection
auwa.uk	UK legal protection

Registrar: UK2.net (consistent with More Air domains). **Email:** hello@auwa.life (configured), plus platform-specific aliases. **Not available:** auwa.art. **Pre-existing:** auwaworld.com (registered ~2017).

SOCIAL HANDLES

See `context/marketing/social.md` for the full, current social account map (handles, logins, status, pending verifications, and outstanding steps). `social.md` is the single source of truth and is updated whenever the social landscape changes.

Summary: one brand, three handle variants by necessity. `@auwalife` is the default, `@auwa.life` is used on TikTok and Bluesky (where dots are permitted and match the domain), `@auwa` on LinkedIn (pure brand name, pre-owned). All accounts route to `social@auwa.life`.

COSTS SUMMARY

Item	Cost	Status
Word mark Batch 1 (Classes 9, 16, 20, 41)	£320	Paid
TM3A amendment (declined)	£150	Paid (refunded)
TM16 ownership transfer	£50	Paid
Auwa Limited incorporation	~£50	Done
Domains (~11)	~£51	Secured
Word mark Batch 2 (Classes 25, 28, 35)	£325	Paid

Design mark UK (Classes 20, 28)	£265	Paid
Total spent	~£1,061	
Madrid word mark (7 classes × US/EU/CN; JP 6 classes)	CHF 7,571	Forms prepared 20 Jul; pay via More Air
Madrid design mark (2 classes × JP/US/EU/CN)	CHF 3,169	Forms prepared 20 Jul; pay via More Air
Madrid IPO handling (2× £50)	£100	Pay via More Air
Madrid total	CHF 10,740 (~£9,600) + £100	Re-run calculator before paying
Estimated total IP spend	~£10,800	

KEY DATES & DEADLINES

Date	Event
15 Feb 2026	Auwa Limited incorporated. Word mark Batch 1 filed (UK00004341028)
23 Feb 2026	IP assignment + license agreements signed
24 Feb 2026	TM16 ownership transfer filed
26 Feb 2026	TM16 confirmed
27 Feb 2026	Word mark Batch 1 examination complete
6 Mar 2026	Word mark Batch 1 enters advertisement (opposition) period
16 Apr 2026	Design mark filed (UK00004373930), Classes 20 + 28
16 Apr 2026	Word mark Batch 2 filed (UK00004373944), Classes 25, 28, 35
15 May 2026	Word mark Batch 1 REGISTERED (UK00004341028)

3 Jul 2026	Design mark published for opposition (journal 2026/027); window ends ~3 Sep 2026
15 Jul 2026	Decision to file Madrid comprehensively; McLoughlin confirms pending marks can't be expedited
20 Jul 2026	Madrid applications FILED — word mark + design mark, JP/US/EU/CN, emailed to IPO
~5 days after	IPO payment receipt expected
~15 working days after	IPO certification (or deficiency notice) expected
~3 Sep 2026	UK opposition window ends for Batch 2 word mark + design mark
~17 Sep 2026	Batch 2 word mark + design mark expected to REGISTER (if unopposed)
(12–18 months)	Designated offices (JP/US/EU/CN) grant protection or issue provisional refusals

OPEN ACTIONS

1. **Design mark filing — DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373930. Classes 20 + 28. £265.
2. **Word mark additional classes — DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373944. Classes 25, 28, 35. £325.
3. **Madrid Protocol filing — FILED 20 Jul 2026.** Both MM2s (+ FS4, continuation, MM18) emailed to the IPO. Word mark CHF 7,571 (JP class 25 dropped), design mark CHF 3,169, both JP/US/EU/CN. £50 handling fee paid per mark (refs HJ74X644X6 word / KUVHCCJHVR design). **Now open:** (a) watch for IPO payment receipt (~~5 days~~) and certification (~~15 working days~~); (b) **pay WIPO the CHF fees** when billed, from More Air; (c) respond to any WIPO irregularity; (d) later, respond to any provisional refusals from JP/US/EU/CN (likely needs local counsel — flag to Claude). See "What happens next" under INTERNATIONAL FILING.
4. **Word mark Batch 1 opposition period — DONE.** Registered 15 May 2026, no opposition. 4b. **Design mark opposition window** — published 3 July 2026; monitor until ~3 September 2026. UKIPO notifies if opposed; no action otherwise. 4c. **Batch 2 registration** — still pending; monitor (part of the McLoughlin expedite ask). Rides in the

Madrid filing on the pending application until registered (central-attack dependency until then).

5. **Royalty structure** — When Auwa generates revenue, add royalty terms to the More Air license. Accountant review needed.
6. **Social handle registration** — Secure across remaining platforms (see handles table above).

LEGAL PRINCIPLES (Reference)

- **No attorney hired.** All filings done DIY to date.
- **Personal ownership = personal liability.** Corrected by assigning IP to Auwa Limited.
- **Use in commerce requirement:** Must actually use trademark in each registered class within 5 years or risk cancellation for non-use.
- **Paris Convention:** First filing gives 6 months to file in other jurisdictions with the same priority date (15 Feb 2026).
- **Nominal consideration (£1):** Makes agreements legally binding under English contract law.
- **Standard black-on-white design marks** allow enforcement in any colour (KAWS precedent).

KEY CONTACTS

	Detail
Tom Vining, Producer	tom@moreair.co
Rieko Maeda, Creator	rieko@moreair.co
Auwa	hello@auwa.life
More Air	moreair.co
Companies House	Auwa Ltd 17033727, More Air Ltd 7051794

FILE LOCATIONS

All original documents stored in Dropbox:

Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/

- |— corporation/ — Company incorporation documents
- |— trademark/
 - | |— 1 license/
 - | | |— _archive/ — Original (superseded) license
 - | | |— 20260223_auwa_assignment.* — IP Assignment: personal → Auwa Ltd
 - | | |— 20260223_auwa_license.* — Operating license: Auwa Ltd → More

Air Ltd

- | |— 2 word mark/
 - | | |— application/
 - | | | |— batch 1/ — Original 4-class filing + examination + advertisement
 - | | | |— batch 2/ — Additional 3-class filing (16 Apr 2026)
- | | |— exclusions/
 - | | | |— juno-international.txt — Japan conflict analysis
 - | | | |— wipo-results.png — WIPO search results
 - | | | |— ownership/ — TM16 transfer to Auwa Ltd
- | |— 3 design mark/
 - | | |— application/ — Design mark filing (16 Apr 2026)
 - | | |— artwork/ — Prepared character silhouettes
 - | | |— evidence/ — Creation date evidence (2016–2020)
 - | | |— search/ — WIPO + Google search results
- |— costing/ — Financial planning
- |— domains/ — Domain registration records
- |— office/ — Virtual office details